MEDIA & RECOGNITION KIT

SWABIR SHARIFF

Founder & Executive Director, The Good Guides · Leadership Advisor & Speaker

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10,000+
YOUNG PEOPLE MENTORED ACROSS TORONTO SINCE 2020

1 of 100
QECT 100 YOUNG LEADERS AWARDEE 2026

2020
FOUNDED THE GOOD GUIDES IN SCARBOROUGH — YOUTH-LED, ON THE GROUND SINCE DAY ONE

ABOUT

Swabir Shariff served as a Director of Security in Scarborough, leading 24/7 security operations for a major retail centre — a role he held while founding The Good Guides in 2020 in Scarborough, Toronto. The Good Guides is a grassroots non-profit incorporated in Ontario built on a simple conviction: young people follow mentors who come from their own community. The organization runs youth mentoring, youth engagement, violence prevention and co-op placement programs. Since 2020 it has mentored 10,000+ young people across Toronto and helped direct over a million dollars in investment into The Good Guides and other Scarborough youth initiatives.

SELECTED COVERAGE & PUBLIC RECORD

Scarborough Mirror — “Open door” for Scarborough youth

PROFILE FEATURE · NOVEMBER 2021

Profile feature by Mike Adler — “‘Open door’ for Scarborough youth lets Good Guide Ambassadors choose how they want to help” — profiling Swabir Shariff and the youth-led mentoring model behind The Good Guides. Published by the Scarborough Mirror on Toronto.com, November 16, 2021.

Read the profile →

Global News — “Making a Difference”

TELEVISION FEATURE · DECEMBER 2021

Featured on Global News Toronto’s “Making a Difference” segment, interviewed by anchor Susan Hay about The Good Guides’ work with young people across the city. The segment (2:46) is embedded on The Good Guides homepage and hosted on the organization’s YouTube channel.

Watch the segment →

City of Toronto — Youth Violence Prevention Grant recipient

CITY OF TORONTO NEWS RELEASE · JUNE 27, 2023

The City of Toronto named The Good Guides among the recipients of its Youth Violence Prevention Grant — a citywide program envelope — funding violence de-escalation programming in priority communities.

Read the news release →

RECOGNITION

One Young World — Ambassador Spotlight

PROFILE FEATURE · SEPTEMBER 2026

Profiled in One Young World's Ambassador Spotlight (September 2026) as founder of The Good Guides — recognized for youth mentorship, violence prevention, and opening doors through sports and co-op placements for young people ages 11–18.

Read the profile →

QECT 100 Young Leaders Awardee 2026

Named a Queen Elizabeth II Commonwealth Trust (QECT) 100 Young Leaders Awardee for 2026; presented at Asprey in London in October 2026, and received at St James's Palace.

Scarborough Walk of Fame — Rising Star

Inducted into the Scarborough Walk of Fame as a Rising Star on April 10, 2024, for founding The Good Guides and leading full-time youth engagement and violence prevention in Scarborough.

Official inductee page →

CharityVillage — Best Individual Contribution to Youth Engagement

Winner of CharityVillage's 2021 award for Best Individual Contribution to Youth Engagement, for building opportunities for young people through The Good Guides.

> *His philosophy, in his own words: to change the starting line for young people — not just cheer them on from it.*

MEDIA & SPEAKING ENQUIRIES

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SCARBOROUGH WALK OF FAME RISING STAR · QECT 100 Young Leaders Awardee 2026